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Key Names and Definitions

POLITICAL SCIENCE

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PART 1: Key Names & Contributions

1 — Aristotle / أرسطو

Contributions:

- First to systematically study politics in ancient Greece
- Defined politics as seeking "the highest good" as the end of political science
- Paid attention to how officials are selected and the nature of political structures
- Considered a founder of political science alongside Machiavelli

عمل إيه:

أول من درس السياسة بشكل منهجي في اليونان القديمة. عرّف السياسة كسعي نحو "أعلى خير". اهتم بكيفية اختيار المسؤولين وطبيعة الهياكل السياسية. يُعتبر مؤسساً لعلم السياسة.

2 — Plato / أفلاطون

Contributions:

- Studied politics as moral philosophy focused on the ideal state
- Viewed politics primarily in terms of moral purposes that decision-makers ought to pursue
- Believed the polis existed to seek the common good, civic virtue, and moral perfection

عمل إيه:

درس السياسة من منظور أخلاقي ومثالي. كان مهتم بالدولة المثالية والفضيلة المدنية. رأى إن السياسة لازم تسعى للخير المشترك.

3 — Niccolo Machiavelli / نيكولو ميكيافيلي

Contributions:

- 15th century Italian political thinker
- Shifted political science from moral philosophy to study of real existing institutions
- Introduced the modern idea of power — how to get it and how to use it

- Considered a founder of political science alongside Aristotle

عمل إيه:

في القرن الخامس عشر حوّل علم السياسة من الفلسفة الأخلاقية المثالية لدراسة السلطة الواقعية. سأل: إزاي تاخذ السلطة وإزاي تحافظ عليها؟ يُعتبر مؤسس علم السياسة الحديث.

4 — Francis Lieber / فرانسيس ليبير

Contributions:

- Professor of History and Political Science at Columbia University
- His work "Civil Liberty and Self Government" made significant contribution to political science as an academic discipline

عمل إيه:

أستاذ في جامعة كولومبيا. كتبه "الحرية المدنية والحكم الذاتي" كان من أهم الإسهامات في تأسيس علم السياسة كتخصص أكاديمي.

5 — John W. Burgess / جون دبليو بورجيس

Contributions:

- Established the Faculty of Political Science at Columbia University in 1880
- In 1886, inaugurated the Political Science Quarterly — the first scholarly journal of political science

عمل إيه:

أسس كلية العلوم السياسية في جامعة كولومبيا 1880. أطلق أول مجلة علمية متخصصة في علم السياسة سنة 1886.

6 — Harold Laski / هارولد لاسكي

Contributions:

- Defined the state as: "a territorial society divided into government and subjects claiming within its allotted physical area, a supremacy over all other institutions"

عمل إليه:

قدّم تعريفاً كلاسيكياً للدولة — مجتمع إقليمي مقسوم لحكام ومحكومين يدّعي السيادة العليا على كل المؤسسات الأخرى في نطاقه الجغرافي.

7 — Oppenheim / أوبنهايم not Oppenheimer 😊

Contributions:

- Defined the state as: "The state exists when a people is settled in a country under its own sovereign government"

عمل إليه:

قدّم تعريفاً مبسطاً للدولة — الدولة توجد عندما يستقر شعب في بلد تحت حكومته ذات السيادة.

8 — Max Weber / ماكس ويبر

Contributions:

- Identified three elements of the state: Territoriality, Violence, and Legitimacy
- Defined the state as holding the monopoly of legitimate use of physical force
- Said: "force is certainly not the normal or only means of the state"
- Influenced political science through his sociological approach

عمل إليه:

حدّد ثلاثة عناصر للدولة: الإقليم، والعنف المشروع، والشرعية. أشهر فكرة عنده إن الدولة هي الوحيدة المخوّلة باحتكار استخدام القوة المشروعة.

9 — Harold Lasswell / هارولد لاسويل

Contributions:

- Defined politics as "who gets what, when and how"
- Described politics generally as "the shaping and sharing of power"
- Focused on individuals with power rather than the whole political system

عمل إليه:

عرّف السياسة بالجملة الشهيرة "مين بياخذ إيه، امتق وازاي". ركّز على الأفراد اللي بيمتلکوا السلطة وكيفية توزيعها.

ديفيد إيستون / David Easton — 10

Contributions:

- Identified political acts as those that "authoritatively allocate values in a society"
- Developed the concept of the "political system" replacing the older focus on "the state"
- Highlighted the interaction between society and the political process

عمل إيه:

عرّف السياسة كـ "التخصيص السلطوي للقيم في المجتمع". طوّر مفهوم "النظام السياسي" كبديل أوسع من مفهوم "الدولة".

روبرت دال / Robert A. Dahl — 11

Contributions:

- Criticized Aristotle's definition of politics as too restrictive
- Reformulated politics as "any persistent pattern of human relationships that involves, to a significant extent, power, rule or authority"
- Argued political science is both art and science
- Was a key figure in the behaviouralist movement

عمل إيه:

انتقد تعريف أرسطو وقَدّم تعريفاً أوسع للسياسة يشمل كل العلاقات الإنسانية المبنية على السلطة. قال إن علم السياسة علم وفن في آن واحد.

ديفيد هيلد / David Held — 12

Contributions:

- Viewed politics as "a practical activity about the discourse and struggle over organization of human possibilities"

- Treated political science as a study of power
- Identified three components: political activity, power, capacity of agents and organizations

عمل إليه:

رأى السياسة كنشاط عملي متعلق بالصراع على تنظيم الإمكانيات البشرية. حدّد ثلاثة مكونات لعلم السياسة: النشاط السياسي، السلطة، قدرة الفاعلين والمؤسسات.

جون سيلي / John Seeley — 13

Contributions:

- Made the famous remark: "History without Political Science has no fruit and Political Science without History has no root"

عمل إليه:

اشتهر بمقولته عن العلاقة التكاملية بين التاريخ وعلم السياسة — كل منهما يحتاج الآخر.

فريمان / Freeman — 14

Contributions:

- Said: "History is past Politics and Politics is present History"

عمل إليه:

صاغ عبارة شهيرة تلخّص العلاقة بين التاريخ والسياسة — الماضي سياسة والسياسة تاريخ حاضر.

آدم سميث / Adam Smith — 15

Contributions:

- Wrote "The Wealth of Nations"
- Pointed out that economics is a science to enrich both people and the state
- Regarded economics and political science as parts of the same subject
- Early thinker who connected economics and political science

عمل إليه:

كتب "ثروة الأمم" وأكد إن الاقتصاد علم لإثراء الشعب والدولة. كان من أوائل من ربط الاقتصاد بعلم السياسة تحت مسمى "الاقتصاد السياسي".

16 — Karl Marx / كارل ماركس

Contributions:

- Argued that the economic factor alone determines the politics of a nation
- Laid the foundation for understanding the relationship between economic base and political superstructure

عمل إيه:

قال إن العامل الاقتصادي هو الوحيد الذي يحدد سياسة أي أمة. أسس الفكر الماركسي القائل بأن من يمتلك وسائل الإنتاج يتحكم في السياسة.

17 — St. Augustine / القديس أوغسطين

Contributions:

- Christian thinker who dwelt upon the idea of an ideal state
- Sought to derive moral and ethical principles regarding governance
- Continued the classical Greek tradition but from a Christian perspective

عمل إيه:

مفكر مسيحي اهتم بفكرة الدولة المثالية من منظور ديني أخلاقي. واصل التقليد الفلسفي اليوناني لكن من زاوية مسيحية.

18 — St. Thomas Aquinas / القديس توما الأكويني

Contributions:

- Christian religious thinker who also dwelt upon the idea of an ideal state
- Sought moral and ethical principles regarding governance like St. Augustine

عمل إيه:

مفكر مسيحي آخر اهتم بتحديد المبادئ الأخلاقية للحكم والدولة المثالية في إطار اللاهوت المسيحي.

19 — William H. Riker / ويليام ريكس

Contributions:

- Main proponent of using deductive, game-theoretic formal modelling in political science
- Led the movement at the University of Rochester in the late 1960s–70s
- Borrowed theory and methods from economics to study political institutions like the US Congress

عمل إيه:

قاد حركة استخدام النمذجة الرياضية ونظرية الألعاب في دراسة السياسة. استعار أدوات من الاقتصاد لدراسة المؤسسات السياسية.

20 — Friedrich Ratzel / فريدريش راتزل

Contributions:

- Credited with the first use of the term "political geography" in his book "Politische Geographie"
- Aligned non-physical geography with the study of the state in space

عمل إيه:

أول من استخدم مصطلح "الجغرافيا السياسية" في كتابه. ربط الجغرافيا غير الطبيعية بدراسة الدولة في الفضاء الجغرافي.

21 — Mackinder / ماكيندر

Contributions:

- Distinguished political and physical geography
- Explored the geographical foundations of state power (geopolitics)
- His work is classified as geopolitics

عمل إيه:

ميّز بين الجغرافيا السياسية والجغرافيا الطبيعية. درس كيف الجغرافيا تحدد قوة الدول — يُعتبر من مؤسسي الجيوبوليتكس.

22 — François Mitterrand / فرانسوا ميتران

Contributions:

- French Socialist President who experienced cohabitation in 1986
- Was forced into cohabitation with rightist premier Jacques Chirac after the legislative elections

عمل إليه:

الرئيس الفرنسي الاشتراكي الذي اضطر للتعايش مع رئيس وزراء يميني (شيراك) بعد انتخابات 1986 — أشهر مثال تاريخي على "Cohabitation".

23 — Jacques Chirac / جاك شيراك

Contributions:

- Rightist premier who served under Socialist President Mitterrand in 1986
- His appointment exemplified cohabitation in the French semi-presidential system

عمل إليه:

رئيس الوزراء اليميني الفرنسي الذي عمل تحت رئيس اشتراكي — مثل أول تجربة تعايش حقيقية في النظام شبه الرئاسي الفرنسي.

24 — Tocqueville / توكفيل

Contributions:

- Sociologist who highly influenced post-WWII political science
- His sociological approach helped bring political science closer to society

عمل إليه:

عالم اجتماع أثّر في علم السياسة بعد الحرب العالمية الثانية وساعد في ربطه بالمجتمع.

25 — Talcott Parsons / تالكوت بارسونز

Contributions:

- Sociologist who influenced post-WWII political science
- Contributed to bringing political science closer to social reality

عمل إليه:

عالم اجتماع ساهم في توجيه علم السياسة نحو دراسة الواقع الاجتماعي بعد الحرب العالمية الثانية.

PART 2: All Definitions in the Syllabus

كل التعريفات الموجودة في المنهج

1 — Political Science / علم السياسة

The systematic study of governance by the application of empirical and generally scientific methods of analysis, examining the state, its organs, institutions, political behavior, political systems, and the distribution and transfer of power in decision-making.

2 — Politics / السياسة

According to Lasswell: "who gets what, when and how." According to Easton: the authoritative allocation of values in a society. According to Held: a practical activity about the discourse and struggle over the organization of human possibilities. More broadly: activities of cooperation, negotiation, and struggle over the use, production, and distribution of resources.

3 — State / الدولة

An organized political community acting under a government, possessing sovereignty over a clearly defined territory. According to Laski: "a territorial society divided into government and subjects claiming within its allotted physical area, a supremacy over all other institutions." According to Oppenheim: exists when "a people is settled in a country under its own sovereign government."

4 — Government / الحكومة

The system by which a state or community is controlled. The group of people with the authority to govern a country or state at a given time. It has legislative, executive, and judicial powers to administer the state. It is the "brain of the state" — the agency through which the state's collective will is expressed and implemented.

5 — Sovereignty / السيادة

The supreme authority of a state, having two aspects: Internal sovereignty — the state's monopoly of authority inside its boundaries; External sovereignty — the state's independence from other states, where its will is its own and unaffected by any external authority.

6 — Political System / النظام السياسي

According to David Easton: "the interactions through which values are authoritatively allocated for a society." A general set of principles, ideals, and limitations followed by a government regardless of its more specific goals. It defines the process for making official government decisions.

7 — Parliamentary System / النظام البرلماني

A democratic form of government in which the party with the greatest representation in the legislature forms the government, its leader becoming prime minister. The executive branch has the direct or indirect support of the parliament, demonstrated usually by a vote of confidence. The relationship between the executive and legislature is called responsible government.

8 — Presidential System / النظام الرئاسي

A form of government in which the president is the chief executive and is elected directly by the people. All three branches — executive, legislative, and judiciary — are constitutionally independent of each other, and no branch can dismiss or dissolve any other. Total executive responsibility is assigned to the president as an individual.

9 — Semi-Presidential System / النظام شبه الرئاسي

A system of government in which a directly elected president shares executive power with a prime minister and cabinet, with the latter two being responsible to a democratically elected legislature. It offers a middle ground between pure presidential and pure parliamentary systems. Characterized by a balance of power among three political bodies: the president, the government headed by a prime minister, and parliament.

10 — Cohabitation / التعايش

A situation in semi-presidential systems where the President and the Prime Minister come from differing political parties. The term originated in France when the situation first arose in the 1980s. Can create effective checks and balances or a period of bitter tension depending on the attitudes of both leaders.

11 — Ministerial Responsibility / المسؤولية الوزارية

The constitutional principle ensuring the accountability of the government to the legislature and thus to the population. It takes two forms: collective responsibility (the government acts as one entity accountable to parliament) and individual responsibility (each minister is personally accountable for their department and civil servants).

12 — Collective Responsibility / المسؤولية الجماعية

A fundamental convention whereby the government is collectively accountable to parliament for its actions, decisions, and policies. Decisions made by the cabinet are binding on all members of the government. A minister must publicly support government policies even if they privately disagree, and must resign if the government is defeated on a matter of confidence.

13 — Individual Ministerial Responsibility / المسؤولية الوزارية الفردية

A constitutional convention that makes government ministers responsible not only for their own actions, but also for those of their department and all actions taken by their civil servants. In cases of wrongdoing, the minister can be called to take corrective action, apologize, or resign.

14 — Vote of Confidence / تصويت الثقة

The mechanism by which a legislature formally demonstrates its support for the government. If the government loses a vote of confidence, it must resign or seek dissolution of the parliament. It is the primary accountability tool in parliamentary systems.

15 — International Relations / العلاقات الدولية

The study of relationships among countries and the roles of sovereign states, intergovernmental organizations, international non-governmental organizations, and multinational corporations. It is both an academic and a public policy field, analyzing and formulating the foreign policy of states.

16 — Liberalism (IR) / الليبرالية في العلاقات الدولية

A theory emphasizing the impact of ideas on behavior, the quality, dignity, and liberty of the individual, and the need to protect people from excessive state regulation. It views human nature as good and believes war is not inevitable. It emphasizes international cooperation, institutions, free trade, and human rights as means to achieve peace.

17 — Realism (IR) / الواقعية في العلاقات الدولية

A theory based on three assumptions: the state-centric assumption (states are the most important actors), the unitary rational actor assumption (states act as single entities pursuing national interests rationally), and the anarchy assumption (there is no global government above states). Power is the central concept; states seek to acquire, increase, and project power to ensure national survival.

18 — Neorealism / النيو-واقعية

A development of realism that concentrates on "anarchy" as the main structural variable in international relations and provides a more scientific methodology. It disregards individual factors and the characteristics of states, focusing instead on the structure of the international system.

19 — Neoliberalism / النيو-ليبرالية

A new approach to world politics that concentrates on the ways international organizations and other non-state actors promote international cooperation. It emphasizes the prospects for progress, peace, and prosperity through institutional frameworks and cooperation between international actors.

20 — State Actors / الفاعلون الدوليون من الدول

The most important actors in international relations. A state is a territorial entity controlled by a government and inhabited by a population. It exercises sovereignty over its territory to make and enforce laws, collect taxes, and so forth.

21 — Non-State Actors / الفاعلون من غير الدول

Entities that are not national governments but that strongly constrain and influence international relations. They include sub-state actors (interest groups within states), transnational actors (entities operating across state borders), MNCs, and NGOs.

22 — Multinational Corporations — MNCs / الشركات متعددة الجنسيات

Thousands of corporations that operate internationally and are important transnational actors. Their interests do not correspond with any one state's interests. They often control greater resources and operate internationally with greater efficiency than many small states.

23 — Non-Governmental Organizations — NGOs / المنظمات غير الحكومية

Transnational actors that are not governments and do not seek profit. Examples include Greenpeace and the International Olympic Committee. They operate across borders and influence international relations through advocacy, humanitarian work, and public pressure.

24 — Intergovernmental Organizations — IGOs / المنظمات الدولية الحكومية

Organizations whose members are national governments. Examples include the UN, the World Bank, and the IMF. They can be classified by function (general-purpose like the UN, or specialized like the WHO) or by geographic scope (global or regional like the EU or the African Union).

25 — Territoriality / الإقليمية

According to Weber, the first element of the state. The state controls a clearly defined and internationally recognized territory. Territory includes land, water, and airspace within defined borders, and belongs to the state — not to the government.

26 — Legitimacy / الشرعية

According to Weber, the third element of the state. The justifiability behind the state's use of force. Legitimacy may be based on belief (people believe the state has the right to use force), law, or constitution. It is what distinguishes the state's use of force from other organizations' use of force.

27 — Comparative Politics / السياسة المقارنة

The study of politics outside one country or politics compared across countries. It includes the study of governing institutions, electoral behavior and procedures, public policy, political economy, social movements, and revolution. It focuses on politics within countries and analyzes similarities and differences between them.

28 — Political Theory / النظرية السياسية

The oldest field in political science, finding its roots in the ancient theories of Aristotle and Plato. It integrates timeless questions about political ideology, fairness, justice, and equity. It includes classical political philosophy and contemporary theoretical perspectives.

29 — Public Policy / السياسة العامة

A broad field that explores substantive policy areas as well as the procedures of policy-making. Examples of substantive areas include social welfare policy, communications policy, and morality policy. It examines the passage and implementation of government policies related to civil rights, defense, health, education, and economic growth.

30 — Public Administration / الإدارة العامة

The field of political science that studies the role of the bureaucracy. It is the most practically oriented subfield and often prepares students for careers in the civil service. It focuses on how government agencies implement laws and policies.

31 — Behaviouralism / السلوكية

A movement in political science from the 1950s that shifted focus from studying political institutions to studying the day-to-day behaviour of individuals in political society. It advocated the use of statistical methods and tools to draw scientific conclusions and sought to make political science inter-disciplinary.

32 — Post-Behaviouralism / ما بعد السلوكية

A movement that emerged in the late 1960s as a reaction to behaviouralism. It sought to make political science relevant to society and not just scientifically rigorous. It pushed for a plurality of methodologies and emphasized the real-world application of political knowledge.

33 — Science / العلم

The systematic observation of nature, events, and conditions in order to discover facts about them and to formulate laws and principles based on these facts. An organized body of knowledge derived from observations that can be verified or tested by further investigation.

34 — Art (in political science) / الفن في علم السياسة

The practical application of knowledge for the achievement of a particular goal. Political science is an art when its knowledge is applied practically — for example, in drafting a constitution, conducting diplomatic relations, or administering the day-to-day affairs of a state.

35 — Geopolitics / الجيوبوليتكس

The study of how geographical foundations — particularly physical geography, state territories, and resources — influence state power and the relationships between powerful states and other parts of the world. It examines how geography conditions political decisions locally, nationally, and internationally.

36 — Political Geography / الجغرافيا السياسية

A sub-discipline of both geography and political science concerned with the study of the spatial dimensions of politics. It has a particular interest in territory, the state, power, and boundaries across a range of scales. The term was first used by Friedrich Ratzel.

37 — Anarchy (in IR) / الفوضى في العلاقات الدولية

The condition of the international system characterized by the absence of a central world government above states. According to realism and neorealism, this anarchic structure forces states to rely on self-help and power to ensure their survival, making conflict inevitable.

38 — Balance of Power / توازن القوى

A concept in international relations referring to the distribution of power among states in a way that prevents any single state from dominating others. It is a key variable at the international level of analysis and is central to realist theory.

39 — Population / السكان (كعنصر من عناصر الدولة)

The first essential element of the state according to classical theory. The state is a human institution; without people there can be no state. All people living within a state's borders are its members, and their children also accept its membership automatically.

الإقليم (كعنصر من عناصر الدولة) / Territory — 40

The second essential element of the state. Every state requires a fixed geographical area. It includes land, water bodies, natural resources, and the airspace above. Territory belongs to the state — the government is only responsible for protecting it.

خلصنا! 🎯

25 اسم مهم مع إسهاماتهم + 40 تعريف شامل من المنهج كله